

HS 405: Japanese Language Class IV

Course Code	HS 405
Course Name	Japanese Language Class IV
L-T-P-C	3-0-0-3
Prerequisites	Those who have completed Level 3 or are recognized as having equivalent ability
Intended for	UG/PG/Ph.D
Approval	62nd BoA (Jan 2026)

Preamble

Building upon the knowledge of the “Japanese Language Course III”, this course comprehensively enhances the four skills of reading, listening, writing, and speaking.

After taking this course, students will be able to

- Expand vocabulary and kanji knowledge: Learn commonly used JLPT N4 level words and approximately 150 new kanji characters, enabling them to read texts for everyday use, negotiate with people in a wider range of situations, and make detailed statements about themselves and other things.
- Deepen understanding of grammar: Can understand sentence and frequently used expressions related to areas of most immediate relevance (e.g. very basic personal and family information, shopping, local geography, employment).
- Enhance conversational fluency: Can communicate in simple and routine tasks requiring a simple and direct exchange of information on familiar and routine matters. Can describe in simple terms aspects of his/her background, immediate environment and matters in areas of immediate need.
- Develop a deep insight into Japanese culture: Explore the cultural nuances of Japanese society, including etiquette, traditions, modern customs, and the current social issues in Japan, to gain a deeper understanding of the cultural roots of the language.

Course Modules

Classes are conducted according to the textbook ‘Marugoto (Elementary2 A2)’.

Marugoto focuses on communication using Japanese and consists of scene syllabus. It systematically introduces the sentence patterns, grammar, vocabulary and kanji step by step showing every situation where these things are actually used.

Each lesson provides opportunities to read sentences, understand grammar, practice pronunciation and speaking, solve listening comprehension questions and write sentences in Japanese.

About 150 kanji characters are introduced, and a worksheet is provided separately in class to give students the opportunity to practice writing them.

The course also includes a number of opportunities to understand Japanese culture and can be discussed with learners in class.

The textbook Minna no Nihongo and its supplementary materials are also used as part of the main textbook as appropriate.

Homework assignments are given as appropriate to supplement the study content.

[Time of lectures]

- The first lesson is Introduction. (1 hour)
- The second class will review the Lower-Intermediate Course. (1 hour)
- Intermediate Course covers Lessons 1 to 12 of ‘Marugoto (Elementary2 A2)’.
- Each lesson is scheduled for three hours. (36 hours in total)
- Exams (or assignments) are given in the middle and at the end of the semester. (4 hours in total)

(Total of 42 hours planned.)

[Title and Contents of lectures]

Marugoto (Elementary1 A2)

- **Lesson 1 – That’s good name:** Talk about yourself, giving a few details
- **Lesson 2 – She is the person wearing glasses:** Give a description of someone’s physical appearance
- **Lesson 3 – What do you recommend?:** Order a meal, saying what dishes you want and how many of each
- **Lesson 4 – How do you eat this?:** Make a simple presentation about how to eat a particular dish from your country
- **Lesson 5 – You’d better take a hat:** Give advice about a good season, etc. for a trip, based on personal experience
- **Lesson 6 – You can watch a dolphin show:** Talk about activities that interest you at your travel destination and share your impressions
- **Lesson 7 – What do we do if it rains?:** Ask a question related to instructions you heard at a staff meeting
- **Lesson 8 – Has the concert started already?:** Ask/Say at reception how an event is going
- **Lesson 9 – What did you do during your New Year’s holiday?:** Talk about how you spend or spent the annual events
- **Lesson 10 – Wishing for good things to happen:** Write a paragraph explaining the purpose and activities of special occasions and events in your country
- **Lesson 11 – My vacuum cleaner has broken:** In the shopping situation, explain the problem you are currently facing and clearly tell the reason why you are shopping
- **Lesson 12 – This one is cheaper:** Compare two products and say what you think about them

Text Books

1. The Japan Foundation, *MARUGOTO: Japanese language and culture Elementary2 A2 Coursebook for communicative language competences*, SANSYUSYA, Japan, 2014
2. 3A corporation, *Minna no Nihongo Elementary*, 3A corporation, Japan, 2012
3. 3A corporation, *Minna no Nihongo Elementary II*, 3A corporation, Japan, 2013

References

1. Atusko Tokui, *Tabunka kyousei no Komyunike-shon: Nihongo kyouiku no genba kara*, ALC Publishing, Japan, 08APR2020
2. Arc academy, *Hajimete No Nihongo Nouryoku Shiken N4 Tango 1500 (English/ Vietnamese Edition)*, ASK Publishing, Japan, 2016
3. Are Hajikano, *JLPT N4 Listening Comprehension Points & Practice*, 3A network, Japan, 23APR2021
4. Keiko Hoshino, *Drill and Drill the Japanese Language Proficiency Test N4 Vocabulary Grammar/Reading and Listening*, Unicom, Japan, 17FEB2015
5. Kyoko Igarashi, *The Best Complete Workbook for the Japanese-Language Proficiency Test N4 – Language Knowledge (Vocabulary/Grammar), Reading & Listening*, The Japan Times Publishing, Japan, 2022
6. Kyoko Igarashi, *The Best Complete Workbook for the Japanese-Language Proficiency Test N5 – Language Knowledge (Vocabulary/Grammar), Reading & Listening*, The Japan Times Publishing, Japan, 2022
7. Musashino City Returnee and Foreigner Education Counseling Center Teaching Materials Development Group, *80 Easy-to-understand Pictures*, 3A network, Japan, 29MAR2001
8. Noriko Kobayashi, *Mastering Japanese by Ear*, Bonjinsha, Japan, 15FEB2024
9. The Japan Foundation, *IRODORI-Japanese for Life in Japan-Elementary 1*, The Japan Foundation, Japan, 2020
10. Tsuchiya Haruhito, *Customs of Japan*, IBC Publishing, Japan, 04NOV2023
11. Yoji Yamakuse, Michael A. Coony, *Heart & Soul of the Japanese*, IBC Publishing, Japan, 20DEC2023
12. Yukiko Ogata, *Nihongo Fun & Easy II: basic grammar for conversation*, ASK Publishing, Japan, 01FEB2018